

Homework A3 | ECON 0100 | Fall 2026 | Solutions

Solution guide for the teaching team. Answers and working are in red; everything in black is what students see. Students answer on paper and submit selections on Gradescope, where the homework is completion-graded.

The Hogsmeade Candy Shop Saga

Honeydukes and Zonkos are two candy shops in Hogsmeade. Both shops make two types of popular candy, Chocolate Frogs (F) and Ice Mice (M). Devoting all their resources to one good, Honeydukes can make 100 pounds of F or 75 pounds of M each week, and Zonkos can make 200 pounds of F or 100 pounds of M .

Use the production table and opportunity cost table you built in Homework A2.

Production per week	Frogs (F)	Mice (M)
Honeydukes	100	75
Zonkos	200	100

Opportunity cost	of 1F	of 1M
Honeydukes	$\frac{3}{4}$ M	$\frac{4}{3}$ F
Zonkos	$\frac{1}{2}$ M	2 F

PPFs, with M on the vertical as in Homework A1: Honeydukes $M = 75 - \frac{3}{4}F$; Zonkos $M = 100 - \frac{1}{2}F$.

Q1 | Specialization

- a) If the two shops want to jointly produce more, which good should each shop specialize in? Zonkos in F, Honeydukes in M
- b) If each shop fully specializes, how many pounds of each candy do the two shops make in total each week? 200F and 75M

Each shop specializes in its comparative advantage, the good it makes at lower opportunity cost. Frogs cost Zonkos $\frac{1}{2}$ M and Honeydukes $\frac{3}{4}$ M, so Zonkos makes Frogs; Mice cost Honeydukes $\frac{4}{3}$ F and Zonkos 2 F, so Honeydukes makes Mice. Fully specialized, Zonkos makes 200F and Honeydukes 75M, so the pair makes 200F and 75M in total.

Q2 | Terms of Trade

The two shops decide to specialize, trade, and sell each other's goods at their shops.

- a) What's an exchange rate that would facilitate a trade of Ice Mice for Chocolate Frogs? Give it in pounds of F per pound of M . e.g. $\frac{3}{2}$ F per M
- b) Explain why any exchange rate between the two shops' opportunity costs of Ice Mice would work.

- a) Any rate strictly between the two opportunity costs of a pound of Mice works:

$$\frac{4}{3} \text{ F per M} < \text{rate} < 2 \text{ F per M}.$$

$\frac{3}{2}$ or $\frac{5}{3}$ F per M are natural picks; 1 and 3 are outside the range and fail (see Q3).

b) Honeydukes is selling Mice. Making a pound of Mice costs it $\frac{4}{3}$ F of forgone Frogs, so it accepts any price above $\frac{4}{3}$ F per M: it gets more Frogs by trading than by baking them. Zonkos is buying Mice. Making a pound itself costs 2 F, so it accepts any price below 2 F per M: it gets the Mice cheaper by trading than by making them. Between $\frac{4}{3}$ and 2 both conditions hold at once, so both shops beat what they could do alone.

Q3 | Accept or Reject

Suppose both shops specialize according to their comparative advantage: Zonkos makes only Chocolate Frogs and Honeydukes only Ice Mice.

- a) Zonkos offers 1F for each 1M. Which shop rejects the offer, and why? Honeydukes
- b) Honeydukes counters with 1M for 3F. Which shop rejects the counteroffer, and why? Zonkos
- c) They settle on 1M for $\frac{3}{2}$ F and trade 40M for 60F. How much of each candy does each shop end up with? Honeydukes 60F and 35M; Zonkos 140F and 40M

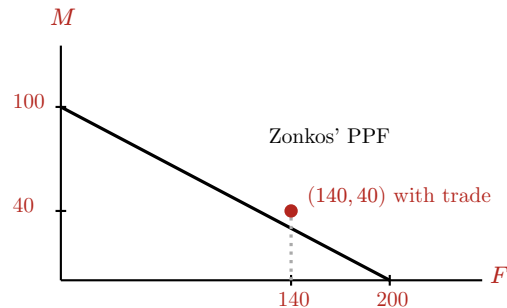
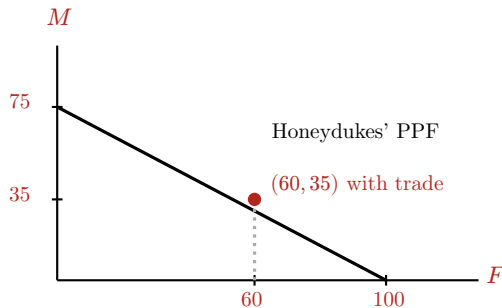
d) Use a graph or algebra to show whether each shop ends up beyond its own PPF. Both do

a) 1 F per M is below Honeydukes' own cost of $\frac{4}{3}$ F per M. Honeydukes can turn a pound of Mice into $\frac{4}{3}$ pounds of Frogs by shifting its own production, so selling a pound for only 1 F is a bad deal, and it rejects. (Zonkos would love it: $1 < 2$.)

b) 3 F per M is above Zonkos' own cost of 2 F per M. Zonkos can make a pound of Mice itself for 2 F, so paying 3 F is worse than staying home, and it rejects. (Honeydukes would love it: $3 > \frac{4}{3}$.)

c) Honeydukes starts with 75M, sends 40M and receives 60F: it ends with 60F and 35M. Zonkos starts with 200F, sends 60F and receives 40M: it ends with 140F and 40M. The rate checks out, $\frac{60}{40} = \frac{3}{2}$ F per M.

d) **Algebra:** Honeydukes' PPF at $F = 60$ allows $M = 75 - \frac{3}{4}(60) = 30$, and it has $35 > 30$. Zonkos' PPF at $F = 140$ allows $M = 100 - \frac{1}{2}(140) = 30$, and it has $40 > 30$. Both consumption bundles lie beyond their own frontiers, which is what a trade inside the Q2 range delivers.



Q4 | Changing Labor

Zonkos' owner decides to go half-time, cutting Zonkos' labor in half.

a) Set up Zonkos' old and new PPF on the same graph. What are Zonkos' new maximum weekly outputs, and what is its new opportunity cost of 1F? 100F or 50M; still $\frac{1}{2}$ M

b) Write a short description of how this change affects the trade with Honeydukes.

a) Half the labor halves both intercepts: 100F or 50M, so the new PPF is $M = 50 - \frac{1}{2}F$, a parallel shift in. Both intercepts fell by the same factor, so the slope, and with it the opportunity cost of a pound of Frogs, is unchanged at $\frac{1}{2}$ M. Less time changes how much Zonkos can make, not the rate at which its two candies trade off.

b) Neither shop's opportunity cost moved, so the range of exchange rates both accept is still $\frac{4}{3}$ to 2 F per M, and the $\frac{3}{2}$ deal from Q3 still works. What changes is the volume: Zonkos now has at most 100F to trade away instead of 200, so the most trade the pair can do falls. (The Q3 trade of 60F is still feasible, but it now takes most of Zonkos' output.)

